

Quidditch 101 - A Real News Segment

Name: _____

Date: _____

Did you know: why "101"?

Good catch – "101" as a way of saying "the basics/an introduction" comes from American university course numbering. The first documented use was at the University of Buffalo in 1929: intro-level courses got the number 101, so students and other colleges could easily tell it was a beginner course. The habit spread from official course catalogues into everyday slang – today you'll see "Adulting 101," "Chess 101," "Cooking 101," all meaning "the basic introduction to X." Worth a quick example round with the group: ask them to invent their own "___ 101" title for something they know well.

Did you know: "March Madness"

The journalist opens with: *"Well if you think March Madness can get crazy, you ain't seen nothing yet."* Worth unpacking, since it's a huge reference for an American audience and probably meaningless to French students without context.

March Madness is the nickname for the NCAA college basketball championship – a single-elimination tournament played every March, so famous it's basically a cultural event in its own right. Tens of millions of Americans fill out a **bracket** (a prediction of every match result, round by round) and enter it into pools with friends, family, or coworkers – so many that US productivity is estimated to drop by billions of dollars every March as people track games at work. Nobody has ever predicted a perfect bracket; the odds of doing so by pure guesswork are roughly 1 in 9.2 quintillion.

Language point: the journalist's opening line follows a common rhetorical pattern for building anticipation: *"If you think X is [adjective], you ain't seen nothing yet."* It sets up a comparison before revealing the actual topic. Worth having students try the pattern themselves – e.g., *"If you think the World Cup final is exciting, you ain't seen nothing yet – wait until you see the penalty shootout."*

1. Vocabulary (10 words)

#	Word / phrase	Meaning
1	chaser	player who scores by throwing the quaffle through a hoop
2	keeper	defends the hoops - "kind of like a goalie"
3	beater	uses bludgers to hit opposing players
4	bludger	a slightly deflated dodgeball, thrown by beaters
5	quaffle	the ball chasers score with - a volleyball
6	seeker	the player who chases and catches the snitch
7	snitch	in real life, a person wearing yellow shorts with a tennis ball attached by a tail
8	hoop	where chasers score points
9	broom	held between the legs while running - no flying involved
10	learning curve	the time and effort it takes to get good at something new

2. Roles - note-taking grid (listening task)

Role	What they do	Any extra detail mentioned
Chaser		
Keeper		
Beater		
Seeker		

3. Gap-fill - real transcript lines

Fill in the missing word as you watch.

1. "We call it like a mix between rugby, _____, and basketball."
2. "They use slightly deflated dodge balls, those are the _____."
3. "There's a person who wears _____ shorts... with a tennis ball attached to them."
4. "Only _____ can catch snitches."
5. "To play Quidditch you gotta have a sense of _____."
6. "There's a learning curve to running with a broom between your _____."

4. True/false check

- The players actually fly on broomsticks, just like in the films.
 - The snitch, in real life, is a ball with wings.
 - A keeper's role is compared to a goalie.
 - The interviewee says you don't need a sense of humour to play.
-

5. Discussion

- The interviewer says Quidditch "may look funny," but the players take it seriously. Does that remind you of anything else we've looked at this week? (*Bridge back to the hobbyhorsing discussion – is it a "real" sport?*)
 - What would your own "sense of humour" sport look like – something a bit silly, but that you'd still want to compete in properly?
-

*This slots naturally alongside the hobbyhorsing/quadball comparison

Quidditch 101 - A Real News Segment

About this video

A short US local news segment ("The Breakdown," presented by Lindsay Granger) about real-life Quidditch, featuring an interview with **Michele Cohen, president of ASU Quidditch** (Arizona State University's team). Genuinely useful because it's a real, unscripted-sounding interview rather than a scripted explainer – natural pacing, some overlapping speech, a bit of banter at the start.

About this activity

B1-B2 only – extension activity, ~20–25 min – built from a real transcript, links back to the hobbyhorsing/quadball comparison piece Not for A1-A2 students: dense, natural-speed audio and heavy US cultural references (March Madness, "101" naming), with no simplified version.

Did you know: "March Madness"

This connects nicely to the ****predictions activity**** you already have (with "will/might/could") – March Madness bracket culture is essentially the same instinct as that activity, just turned into a national obsession. Worth mentioning the word "bracket" itself if you haven't already – useful for describing any knockout-style competition, World Cup included.

2. Roles - note-taking grid (listening task)

Give students this grid before playing the clip. Fill in while watching (play twice if needed).

3. Gap-fill - real transcript lines

1. 1. dodgeball 2. bludgers 3. yellow 4. seekers 5. humor 6. legs

4. True/false check

1. The players actually fly on broomsticks, just like in the films. → False – they run with a broom between their legs
2. The snitch, in real life, is a ball with wings. → False – it's a person wearing yellow shorts with a tennis ball attached by a tail
3. A keeper's role is compared to a goalie. → True
4. The interviewee says you don't need a sense of humour to play. → False – she says the opposite: "you gotta have a sense of humor"